WILEY JOURNALS · AI IN PEER REVIEW

AI in Peer Review

What Wiley allows reviewers to do, what it asks them to disclose, and how editors respond to AI in submissions

Never upload manuscripts

Disclose drafting help

Contact the author first

Summarised from the Wiley AI guidelines page · accessed 26 October 2026

WILEY'S POSITION

AI in peer review in three rules

1
Do not upload

Manuscripts under review are confidential. They must not go into AI tools, in full or in part.

2
Support your own review

AI may help you organise thoughts, prioritise feedback, improve clarity and tone, or translate your review.

3
Disclose drafting help

If AI assisted with drafting your review, say which tool, when, what it did and what you did.

> For editors: AI use in a manuscript is not grounds for rejection at Wiley. Evaluate quality, integrity, disclosure and clarity.

REVIEWERS · PERMITTED AND PROHIBITED

What reviewers may and may not do

Status	Use of AI	Condition
Permitted	Organise your thoughts and prioritise feedback	Disclose if it is drafting help
Permitted	Improve the clarity and tone of your review, or translate it	Disclose drafting assistance
Permitted	Ask general questions about research methods or statistical approaches	No manuscript specifics
Not permitted	Upload a manuscript to an AI tool, in full or in part	No exception in this section

> Not addressed in the peer-review section: having AI write the assessment or recommendation. It is not on the permitted list, so ask the editor.

REVIEWERS · CONFIDENTIALITY

Why the upload ban matters

What the page says

- Manuscripts are confidential to the peer review process.
- Authors have not permitted reviewers or editors to share unpublished work with AI tools.
- The ban covers any portion of the manuscript, not only the full text.

What this means in practice

- Do not paste text, equations, proofs, figures, tables or data from the paper.
- Avoid uploading the abstract or summaries of the paper's specific claims.
- When unsure whether something is manuscript-specific, do not upload it.

REVIEWERS · GENERAL QUESTIONS

General versus manuscript-specific

Allowed: general questions

- What are common pitfalls when comparing line-search methods with performance profiles?
- When is a paired test appropriate for comparing solvers across problems?
- What does a rate of convergence claim usually need to specify?

Not allowed: manuscript specifics

- Here is the proof of Theorem 3 from the paper. Is it correct?
- Here is the paper's results table. Do the claims hold?
- Here is the new method's update rule. Is it novel?

The page allows general method and statistics questions that reference no manuscript specifics. The examples here were written for this deck.

REVIEWERS · DISCLOSURE

Disclosing AI help with your review

When AI assisted with drafting, state

- The tool name and version
- The date or year of use
- The tool's role in drafting or editing
- Your role in directing and reviewing its work

Template statement

“I used [tool, version] in [month, year] to improve the clarity and tone of this review. All original review feedback was provided by me, and I reviewed, revised and approved the final text.”

Adapted from the page's example; the exact wording is mine.

The page does not say where the statement goes. Follow the journal's review form, or tell the handling editor.

EDITORS · EVALUATING SUBMISSIONS

Editors judge the work, not the tool

Do not start from

> “Was AI used here?”

AI use in manuscript development is not grounds for rejection at Wiley.

Ask instead

- Does the manuscript meet the journal's editorial policies and readers' expectations?
- Do the AI disclosures match what appears in the manuscript?
- Are the research and its communication sound, clear and honestly reported?

> Wiley's agreements give journal editors final authority on whether AI use is appropriate. The aim is fair evaluation while the community adapts.

EDITORS · TWO LEVELS OF CONCERN

Editorial review versus integrity concern

Warrants editorial review

Not automatically rejection.

- Citations that do not adequately support claims
- Unclear methodology or analysis
- Poor logical flow or organisation
- Missing context or background
- Writing below the journal's standard

May warrant rejection

Integrity concerns.

- Fabricated citations or references
- Falsified data or methodology
- Inability to verify the research when requested
- Failure to address substantive concerns about validity

EDITORS · HANDLING A CONCERN

Contact the author first

1

Notice

You suspect AI involvement, or a reviewer raises a concern.

2

Ask the author

Contact them first. Focus on specific problems and seek their clarification.

3

Escalate if needed

Follow standard policies. Consult Wiley's Integrity Assurance and Case Resolution team.

4

Decide fairly

Evaluate the manuscript fairly while the community adapts.

> The page does not cover AI-detection tools or how to respond to suspected undisclosed use beyond these steps. Never paste the manuscript into an AI tool to check it.

LOOKING AHEAD

AI Wiley uses, and may use, in peer review

Today: Research Exchange

- Reviewer matching by expertise, availability and review history
- Integrity screening, such as plagiarism and image manipulation, with markers flagged for editors to consider

Possible in future

- AI inside secure editorial environments, sharing nothing confidential externally
- Field-specific prompts for reviewers
- Help structuring feedback, or spotting reviews that lack substantive engagement

These are publisher-side tools and plans. They do not change what reviewers may do with a manuscript today.

COMPARISON

Wiley and Springer Nature in peer review

Topic	Wiley	Springer Nature
Uploading manuscripts	Not to AI tools, in full or in part. No exception stated	Not to public or open tools. Limited use in secure approved tools may be acceptable
Polishing your review	Clarity, tone, translation allowed. Disclose drafting help	Green: describe the use, stay accountable
General questions	Allowed if no manuscript specifics	Amber: verify outputs, manage confidentiality
AI-written assessment	Not addressed. Not on the permitted list	Red: not permitted
Editors and detectors	Contact author first. Detectors not addressed	Seek clarification. Extreme caution with detectors

PRACTICE · OPTIMISATION CASES

What would you do?

A

Reviewer: you paste the proof of Theorem 3 into an LLM to look for gaps.

B

Reviewer: you write your report, then ask an LLM to improve its tone.

C

Reviewer: you ask a chatbot about common pitfalls of performance profiles, naming no paper.

D

Reviewer: you give an LLM your notes and the abstract and ask for a full draft review.

E

Editor: two DOIs in a submission do not resolve and the references look invented.

F

Editor: a reviewer says the paper “reads like AI”, with no specific problems cited.

Cases written for this deck · 12

PRACTICE · SUGGESTED ANSWERS

What the Wiley page implies

Case	Answer	Why
A	Not permitted	Part of the manuscript went into an AI tool. Review the proof yourself.
B	Permitted, disclose	Tone and clarity are allowed. Disclose as drafting help. Do not paste manuscript text for context.
C	Permitted	A general method question with no manuscript specifics. Verify the answer yourself.
D	Not permitted	The abstract is part of the manuscript, and full AI-written reviews are not on the permitted list.
E	Contact the author	Fabricated references may be an integrity concern. Ask the author first, then follow standard processes and consult Integrity Assurance.
F	Ask for specifics	AI use alone is not grounds for rejection. Ask the reviewer and author about concrete problems.

PRACTICE · CHECKLISTS

Before you submit a review or a decision

Reviewers

- ✓ **No uploads.** No part of the manuscript went into an AI tool.
- ✓ **My judgement.** The assessment and recommendation are my own.
- ✓ **General questions only.** Any prompts named no manuscript specifics.
- ✓ **Disclosure.** Tool, version, date, its role and mine are stated.
- ✓ **Reviewed.** I read, revised and approved every AI-edited sentence.

Editors

- ✓ **Right question.** I assessed quality, integrity, disclosure and clarity.
- ✓ **Disclosures match.** What is declared fits what appears in the manuscript.
- ✓ **Author first.** I raised specific concerns with the author before acting.
- ✓ **Right level.** Quality issues and integrity concerns are handled separately.
- ✓ **Escalation.** Integrity concerns followed standard processes.

TAKEAWAYS

Five things to remember

1. **Never upload** any part of a manuscript under review to an AI tool.
2. **Use AI around your review,** not inside the manuscript: organise, polish, translate, ask general questions.
3. **Disclose drafting help** with tool, version, date, its role and yours.
4. **Editors judge the work,** not whether AI was used. Fabricated references are an integrity concern.
5. **Contact the author first,** then follow standard processes and Wiley's Integrity Assurance team.

SOURCES AND SCOPE

Where this guide comes from

Wiley: Using AI tools in your research (peer review section)
wiley.com/publishing/article/ai-guidelines

Springer Nature: AI use in peer review
springernature.com/.../using-ai-in-peer-review

Springer Nature: AI guidance for editors
springernature.com/.../ai-editor-guidance

Scope and caveats

> The Wiley page was read on 26 October 2026 through a summarising tool. Wording is paraphrased apart from short quotes.

> The page is silent on AI-written assessments, detection tools and where a reviewer's disclosure goes.

> The comparison, scenarios, checklists and template statement are written for this deck, not publisher text.